City Hospital Medication Safety Policy

The Five Rights

Before giving any medication, the nurse checks the five rights: right patient, right drug, right dose, right route and right time.

Patient identity is confirmed with 2 identifiers, the full name and the date of birth, before every dose.

Never use the room number to identify a patient.

High-Alert Medications

Insulin, heparin and potassium chloride are high-alert medications in this hospital.

High-alert medications require an independent double check by a second nurse before administration.

Concentrated potassium chloride is stored only in the pharmacy, never on the ward.

Timing and Documentation

Scheduled medications may be given up to 30 minutes before or after the prescribed time.

Every dose is documented in the electronic health record immediately after administration.

If a patient refuses a medication, the nurse records the refusal and informs the doctor.

Errors and Reporting

Any medication error is reported through the incident system within 24 hours.

Reporting an error is never punished; the goal is to fix the system, not to blame people.

Oral morphine doses are checked against the controlled drugs register at every shift change.

Patient Observations

Vital signs are recorded at least every 4 hours for patients on the surgical ward.

A respiratory rate above 24 breaths per minute is escalated to the nurse in charge.

Pain is scored on a scale from zero to ten and reassessed 30 minutes after giving pain relief.

The early warning score is calculated with every set of observations.